

GDT

Your product is exceptional. Your traveller can't find it.

GDT is the marketplace built for India's experiential travel operators.

Adventure Sports · Wellness Retreat · Cultural Events · Social Immersion

Founding Partner Cohort

greatdtour.com

Section 01

The Market Opportunity

Why this moment matters — and why it won't wait.

India's experiential travel sector is accelerating — fast.

₹21 TN

T&T contribution to India's GDP in 2024 —
20% above pre-pandemic levels

WTTC Economic Impact Research, 2025

17.8%

CAGR — India adventure tourism market
2025–2033

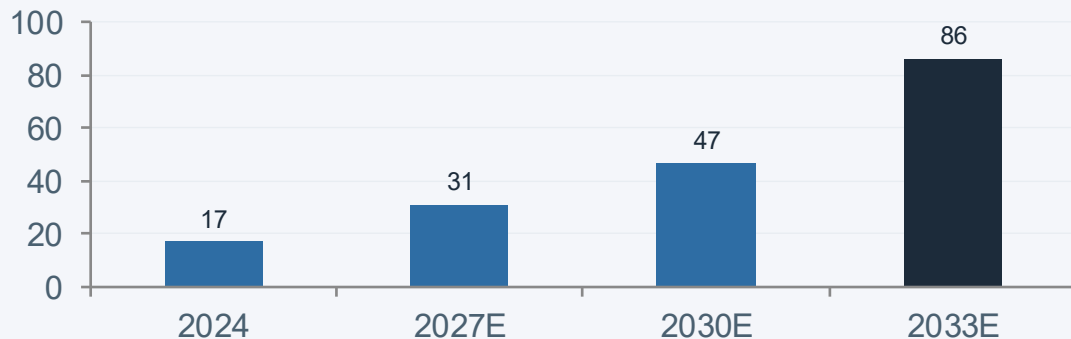
IMARC Group, 2024

USD 18 BN

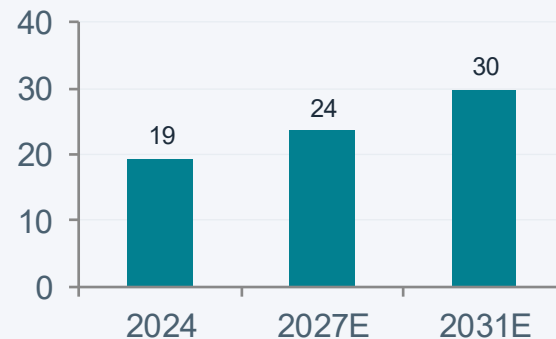
Projected wellness tourism GDP
contribution by 2030

Ministry of Tourism & NITI Aayog

Adventure Tourism — India (USD BN)



Wellness Tourism (USD BN)



A new traveller is reshaping the category.



25–45, urban

Digitally fluent. Researches deeply before booking. Prioritises experience over convenience.



Rising spend

Leisure travel: 42.5% of Indian foreign departures in 2024. Shorter, more intentional breaks replacing long generic holidays.



Tier II & III emerging

First-time experiential travellers from non-metro cities entering the market with growing disposable income.



Trust-first buyer

Willing to pay premium for verified operators. Abandons the booking process when trust signals are absent.



Specialist-seeking

Not looking for a package. Looking for an operator with genuine domain expertise in their chosen category.



20M international arrivals

India welcomed 20M international visitors in 2024 — 2.3M more than 2019. Inbound spend at record ₹3.1TN.

Section 02

The GDT Platform

Built by people who know the gap — and built to close it.

Four categories. One platform. Built for all of them.



Adventure Sports

- Trekking & mountaineering
- 4x4 / motorbike / cycling expeditions
- Rock climbing & trail running
- Scuba, surfing, sailing, kayaking
- Paragliding, skydiving, skiing
- Self-drive & car rally



Wellness Retreat

- Yoga, Ayurveda & meditation
- Luxury spa & sleep retreats
- Biohacking & digital detox
- Mental health retreats
- Medical & beauty tourism
- Farm & sexual wellness



Cultural Events

- Pilgrimage & religious circuits
- Folk & music festivals
- Culinary & craft festivals
- Creative cultural immersion
- Living traditions programmes



Social Immersion

- Craft & artisan immersion
- Volunteer & env. tourism
- Survival & jungle training
- 4x4 & rally training schools
- Culinary & cultural immersion
- Mentorship experiences

Also includes: practitioners, domain experts, travel influencers entering curated experiences, and local guides building their first operation.

200+ years of combined expertise. Built to close one gap.



Marketplace Strategy

Designed and scaled multi-sided marketplaces across categories.



Product & Engineering

Built consumer-facing booking and commerce infrastructure.



Performance Marketing

Run demand generation for consumer brands at scale.



Travel Domain

Operators, guides, and strategists from within the experiential travel industry.

What makes GDT different

- Not a generic travel marketplace — built end-to-end for the experiential travel category.
- Specialised marketing reaches high-intent travellers, not casual browsers.
- Pre-sales and post-booking support handled by the GDT team — not by you.
- Commission model means GDT's incentives are fully aligned with your revenue.
- Curation is real: every operator on the platform has been reviewed and approved.

Section 03

What You Get

The infrastructure you don't have to build.

What running your operation looks like — with and without GDT.

WITHOUT GDT	WITH GDT
PDF itinerary, resent manually to every enquiry	Live listing — updated once, visible always. Zero redistribution cost.
Refund policy verbal — disputed after every cancellation	Published policy agreed at booking. GDT processes refunds end-to-end.
Personal UPI link, manual reconciliation	Integrated gateway — every transaction recorded automatically.
Same FAQ answered for every new enquiry	GDT pre-sales team handles qualification — you receive leads, not queries.
Social media, paid ads, agency — ongoing overhead	GDT marketing team runs campaigns at Growth and Full Partner slabs.
Website maintenance — dev cost, broken links, stale content	GDT storefront and listings replace the product-facing website.
Sales rep for follow-up and conversion — salary overhead	Platform infrastructure handles follow-up and booking conversion.

Six things GDT puts on your side from day one.



Professional Listing

Full itinerary, policies, pricing, calendar — structured and bookable. Replaces your PDF and website.



Pre-Sales Support

GDT team handles FAQs and qualifies enquiries before they reach you. You receive leads, not raw queries.



Booking & Notifications

Instant or request-to-confirm booking flows. A receipt, reminders, and pre-trip WhatsApp g



Flexible Payments

Booking amount on GDT, balance direct to vendor or full payment on-platform for GST-registered operators.



Verified Reviews

Post-trip review requests sent automatically. Only confirmed bookers can leave a rating — trust that matters



Marketing Support

Organic and paid campaigns from GDT's team. Partners receive organic support at any comm

GDT handles the sales process. You handle the experience.

PRE-SALES



FAQ & Enquiry Handling

GDT answers standard questions about categories, fitness requirements, gear, permits, and logistics. Enquiries that reach your dashboard have already been qualified.

PRE-SALES



Lead Qualification

Travellers are assessed for alignment with your product before you invest time in the conversation. No cold enquiries, no repeat explanations.

BOOKING



Automated Notifications

Booking requests, confirmations, receipts, payment reminders — all triggered automatically for both you and the traveller at every stage.

PRE-TRIP



WhatsApp Group Setup

Every confirmed booking triggers a dedicated pre-trip group. You are the admin. GDT sets it up. Last-minute logistics and updates in one managed channel.

POST-BOOKING



Payment Follow-up

Automated payment confirmation and follow-up. No chasing partial payments over message. The platform handles the collections cycle.

POST-TRIP



Review Collection

GDT sends a verified review request to every traveller who completed a booking. Only confirmed bookers can leave a rating — building credibility passively.

Two payment options — built for how India's experiential market works.

OPTION 1

Booking amount on GDT Balance direct to vendor

- Traveller pays booking amount through GDT's payment gateway to confirm their slot.
- Booking amount = your commission rate on the total package price.
- Traveller pays the balance directly to you — cash, UPI, whatever works on the ground.
- GDT's guaranteed refund covers the amount paid through the platform.
- Available to all vendors regardless of GST status.

OR

OPTION 2

Full payment on GDT Platform-settled

- Traveller pays the complete package amount through GDT's payment gateway.
- GDT settles to you on the agreed payment schedule.
- Full guaranteed refund commitment covers the complete booking amount.
- Available to vendors who are GST registered and compliant.

Section 04

The Commercial Model

Commission only. Aligned incentives. No hidden costs.

Commission only when you earn. No listing fee. No pay-to-play.

Slab	Commission	Marketing Support Included
Volunteer	0% — Free	Organic marketing for founding partners. Vendor story published pre-launch.
Starter	Competitive rate	Platform visibility and discovery. Founding partners get organic support regardless.
Growth	Mid rate	Organic marketing — GDT promotes your listings and stories across owned and social channels.
Full Partner	Premium rate	Organic + Paid — GDT runs targeted social and search campaigns directly on your listings.

Specific percentages discussed during onboarding in context of your category and booking volume.

What the commission covers:

- ✓ Platform infrastructure & listing · Payment processing (no separate gateway fee) · Pre-sales FAQ and lead qualification
- ✓ Post-booking notifications & communications · Pre-trip WhatsApp group setup · Cancellation & refund processing
- ✓ Badge system & verified reviews · Marketing support at your chosen slab

Section 05

The Founding Partner Cohort

Five to seven operators per category. This window closes.

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01

Rate locked — 2 years

Your chosen commission slab is contractually fixed for two years across unlimited listings. As GDT scales, new vendor rates will reflect the platform's value. Yours will not change.

02

Organic marketing from day one

All founding partners receive organic marketing support from go-live — regardless of commission slab. For new vendors after the cohort, this only unlocks at the Growth slab and above.

03

Vendor story published pre-launch

GDT's editorial team interviews you before the marketplace goes live. Your story is published and promoted through GDT's channels. You don't start from zero visibility on launch day.

Review records, badge status, and booking history cannot be backdated. Starting earlier means building them sooner.

Section 06

Is GDT Right for You?

An honest self-check before you apply.

GDT is a strong fit if any of these describe your operation.



Serious product, limited reach

Your experience is well-designed and well-run — but the right traveller can't easily find it or trust it when they do.



Friction in your booking process

PDFs, personal payment links, WhatsApp threads — and the disputes and drop-offs that come with them.



Adventure or expedition operator

Any format — trekking, mountaineering, water sports, expedition, rally, self-drive — across any Indian state.



Wellness or retreat programme

Fixed-duration programme with a clear outcome and accommodation. Yoga, Ayurveda, meditation, biohacking, mental health.



Cultural or pilgrimage operator

Multi-day programmes built around festivals, circuits, traditions, culinary journeys — where local depth is the product.



Practitioner or local expert

Ayurveda practitioner, 4x4 trainer, mental health coach, local guide ready to build their first bookable experience.

GDT is also built for experts, practitioners, and guides entering the market.



Skilled Practitioners

4x4 trainers, rally schools, Ayurveda/naturopathy practitioners, mental health coaches, sexual wellness facilitators, team building experts. If you have a credentialed practice and a repeatable group programme format, GDT gives it a bookable professional presence.



Domain Experts

Specialists entering curated travel — mountaineers designing summit programmes, craft practitioners launching immersions, culinary experts running regional food circuits. Deep expertise plus a product concept is enough to begin.



Travel Influencers

Content creators with an audience in a specific travel category who are ready to translate that into a structured product. GDT provides the booking and commercial infrastructure instead of a WhatsApp sign-up thread.



Local Guides

Guides ready to transition from sub-contractor to experience operator. GDT provides the booking, payment, and marketing infrastructure to make the transition commercially viable from day one.



GDT does not provide on-ground operational support at this stage. Programme delivery, safety, and participant welfare remain entirely the operator's responsibility.

Section 07

Onboarding

From application to live listing in six steps.

Six steps, application to live — most founders live in three weeks.

1



Application

15-min form at greatdtour.com. Operation overview, categories, certifications. GDT responds within 5 working days.

2



Onboarding Call

Platform walkthrough. Commission slab and payment model selection. Listing structure guidance.

3



Listing Build

GDT reviews your draft. Badge assessment. Pre-trip WhatsApp group configured.

4



Vendor Story

30-min editorial interview. Your story published and promoted through GDT's channels pre-launch.

5



Go Live

Listing published. Short-link issued. Payment gateway active. Storefront live.

6



First 60 Days

GDT monitors performance, provides optimisation guidance. Founding partners: organic marketing begins immediately.

The ask is simple.

- 1 Apply at greatdtour.com — 15 minutes.
- 2 GDT reviews your application — 5 working days.
- 3 Onboarding call to select your slab and build your listing.
- 4 Live within three weeks.

Apply at greatdtour.com

Founding partner cohort · 5–7 operators per category · Positions fill on a rolling basis

Section FAQ

Frequently Asked Questions

General and category-specific — answered directly.

Frequently asked questions — applies to all vendor categories.

Q Is there a listing fee or upfront cost?

No. GDT operates on commission-per-completed-booking only. You are charged nothing to apply, onboard, or list. You pay when you earn.

Q What does the commission actually cover?

Platform infrastructure, payment processing (no separate gateway fee), pre-sales FAQ handling, post-booking notifications, WhatsApp group setup, cancellation and refund processing, badge system, review collection, and marketing at your chosen slab.

Q Can I still use my own website, social media, and channels?

Yes. GDT does not require exclusivity. Your GDT short-link is specifically designed to bring your existing audience into GDT's booking infrastructure — not to replace it.

Q What is the founding partner rate lock?

Your chosen commission slab is contractually fixed for two years across unlimited listings. New vendors who join after the founding cohort closes will be onboarded at rates that reflect GDT's scale at that point.

Q How does the guaranteed refund work?

GDT's guaranteed refund commitment covers whatever the traveller has paid through the platform. Under Option 1 (booking amount only), the refund covers the booking amount. Under Option 2 (full payment), it covers the full package price.

Q How long does onboarding take?

Most founding partners are live within three weeks of their initial application — subject to listing completeness at submission.

Questions specific to adventure and expedition operators.

Q My trip dates depend on weather windows. Can GDT handle flexible availability?

Yes. You manage your own availability calendar. You can open and close dates, set seasonal windows, and update capacity at any time through your dashboard. Travellers only see available slots.

Q My expeditions have safety certifications (IMF, state tourism, PADI etc.). How does GDT represent these?

GDT's badge system displays safety certifications, operator accreditations, and experience-specific credentials directly on your listing — visible at the moment the traveller is evaluating their options.

Q Can I set different cancellation terms for high-commitment expeditions (e.g. 90-day cutoffs)?

Yes. Your cancellation and refund policy is set at listing level and published transparently. GDT enforces the terms you set — within the platform's minimum standards for traveller protection.

Q I use a mix of cash and digital payments on the ground. Is that compatible with GDT?

Option 1 is specifically designed for this. Travellers pay the booking amount (equal to your commission) through GDT to confirm their slot. You collect the balance directly in whatever format works on the ground — cash, UPI, or otherwise.

Q I offer self-drive and vehicle packages (4x4, motorcycle, cycling). Can GDT list these separately?

Yes. Your listing supports separate vehicle package pricing for 4x4, motorcycle, and cycling configurations within the same experience format.

Q I work with sub-contractors and freelance guides. How does that affect my listing?

Your listing represents your operation and its credentials. Sub-contractor arrangements are your operational decision. GDT assesses the operator applying, not the staffing model.

Questions specific to wellness retreat and practitioner operators.

Q My retreat has limited intake — 8 to 12 participants per cohort. Can GDT manage that?

Yes. Your availability calendar manages capacity per cohort. You set the participant cap at listing level. When a cohort fills, it closes automatically. No overbooking.

Q I run both residential and day programme formats. Can I list both?

GDT's current product focus is on multi-day and overnight experiences. Day-only formats without an accommodation component are not the primary use case — discuss with the onboarding team during your application review.

Q How does GDT handle the pre-retreat screening process (health forms, intake questionnaires)?

The pre-trip WhatsApp group is the managed channel for pre-arrival communications, including screening forms and intake documents. GDT sets it up; you manage the content as admin. — screening form can be added to the product listing

Q My programme involves clinical or therapeutic elements (Ayurveda, naturopathy, mental health). How does GDT handle this?

GDT's badge system can display your practitioner credentials and council registrations. Pre-sales FAQs can include programme-specific health screening guidance so travellers arrive with appropriate expectations.

Q My retreat pricing varies significantly by room type and seasonal period. Can GDT represent this?

Yes. Pricing tiers and availability windows are set at listing level. Different package variants (room type, seasonal rate) can be structured as separate listings under your storefront.

Q I am an independent Ayurveda or naturopathy practitioner, not a registered company. Can I list?

Yes, subject to GDT's non-traditional vendor approval process — which includes practitioner credentials, council registration, prior delivery evidence, and a documented safety and contingency plan.

Questions specific to cultural, immersion, and practitioner operators.

Q My festival or pilgrimage programme runs once or twice a year. Is GDT worth it for low-frequency listings?

Yes. Your listing remains visible year-round. Travellers researching and planning months in advance will find your listing before bookings open. Review records build across cycles, not just within them.

Q I am a craft practitioner or artisan launching my first structured immersion programme.

GDT's non-traditional vendor pathway is designed for this. You will need to demonstrate one prior cohort or documented delivery, a written programme description, and a safety protocol. The onboarding team will guide the process.

Q Can my listing represent multiple cultural experiences across different regions or seasons?

Yes. Each listing represents one experience format. Your storefront displays all your listings together, giving the traveller a view of your full portfolio across regions and seasons.

Q My immersion programme has variable pricing depending on group size and accommodation choices.

Variable pricing can be structured across multiple listing variants. Discuss your specific pricing architecture with the GDT onboarding team to find the right listing format for your programme.

Q My volunteer tourism programme doesn't charge participants — it's a resource and skills exchange.

GDT's Volunteer slab is 0% commission and operates as a form-submission listing rather than a payment transaction. It is complimentary and designed exactly for this format.

Q I run corporate team-building and group immersion programmes. Is GDT the right channel for B2B?

GDT's marketplace is primarily B2C — individual and small-group travellers. Corporate group programmes can be listed, but GDT's demand generation is oriented toward the consumer segment, not procurement teams.